

Classic Chocolate Brownies (Variation 19)

Tags: *dessert, chocolate, baking, american* | Prep: 20 min | Cook: 30 min | Serves: 6

Ingredients

- 82.5 g dark chocolate (70%), chopped
- 63.8 g unsalted butter, cubed
- 112.5 g granulated sugar
- 37.5 g brown sugar
- 1.5 large eggs, room temperature
- 0.8 tsp vanilla extract
- 45 g all-purpose flour
- 15 g unsweetened cocoa powder
- 0.4/2 tsp fine salt
- 37.5 g dark chocolate chips or chunks (optional mix-in)

Method

1. Preheat oven to 180 °C. Grease a 23 x 33 cm baking tin and line with baking paper, leaving an overhang.
2. Melt chocolate and butter together in a heatproof bowl over simmering water (or microwave in 30-second bursts), stirring until smooth. Allow to cool slightly.
3. Whisk both sugars into the chocolate mixture until combined.
4. Add eggs one at a time, whisking well after each addition. Whisk in vanilla.
5. Fold in flour, cocoa powder, and salt with a spatula until just combined — do not overmix.
6. Fold in chocolate chips if using.
7. Pour into prepared tin and spread level.
8. Bake for 25–30 minutes. The top should be set and slightly cracked; a skewer should come out with moist crumbs (not wet batter).
9. Cool completely in the tin before lifting out and cutting into squares.

Chef Tips

- For fudgier brownies, bake for 25 minutes. For cakier, 30 minutes. Err on the side of underbaking.
- Cooling completely before cutting is essential — hot brownies are fragile and will crumble.
- Brown butter instead of plain melted butter adds a toasty, nutty depth that elevates the entire brownie.